

"The potential from India's household rooftops alone is 637 GW, way beyond our current target of 500 GW for the country as a whole. India is a large-scale infrastructure market for clean energy... fourth largest in the world by deployment"

ARUNABHA GHOSH
CEO, Council on Energy, Environment & Water



"When bringing anything new, we start with a pilot project, then we provide some kind of incentive.... We are targeting huge capacities to be installed and produced in the country; so you have to provide that kind of incentives to the generators as well as manufacturers"

RAJIB K. MISHRA
CMD, PTC INDIA

Green energy will play a pivotal role as India charts a course towards a sustainable future. But this, per **Arunabha Ghosh,** CEO of the think tank Council on Energy, Environment & Water, and **Rajib K. Mishra**, CMD of the power trading firm PTC India, will require a fundamental shift in our current energy landscape.

ENERGY BOOST

Mishra: We have 430 GW of installed power capacity and 74 per cent comes from conventional sources. We have to move on to more environment-friendly renewable energy...focus on four pillars: land acquisition, transmission infrastructure or green corridor, availability of financing and enabling regulations to make it more affordable and integrated with the existing system.

Ghosh: When it comes to India's solar and renewable story, the sun has already risen. In 2010, when the National Solar Mission began, we had less than 20 MW of solar power. We have now exceeded 70,000 MW. But the original target of 175 GW of renewables has now become 175 GW of non-fossil fuels, which we have crossed. For this decade, we need to go beyond to the more hybrid systems, the distributed energy systems. And along with our decarbonisation story, we have to tap into our digital infrastructure story and make the two converge.

COMMERCIAL VIABILITY

Ghosh: In India, we need an 'efficient coal-plus-renewable versus inefficient coal' story. We've got to stop thinking about clean energy as just an environmental issue...this decade alone, our renewable story, our green hydrogen story, and our electric mobility story together offer an infrastructure investment opportunity of at least $500 billion (Rs 41.7 lakh crore). We've just not put it under one legislation.

Mishra: The states have to look at the incremental cost of procuring power. If the variable cost of the old thermal plants is more than what they get from the renewable, they will never run that plant. And since they are now accountable, they also have to go to the state regulatory commission each year.

IN MISSION MODE

Ghosh: In January, the cabinet approved the world's second-largest green hydrogen mission after the US. Their target for 2030 is 10 million tonnes per annum; ours is 5 million tonnes. That is huge. But we have to focus on two things as we push the mission forward: keep the domestic market's needs before the international market's and focus on 'demand pull' in addition to 'supply push'. ■